

smooth. In long gaming sessions, the 15R feels less fatiguing and for most gamers, this stability will matter more than theoretical performance ceilings.

CAMERAS

The OnePlus 15R doesn't try to compete with camera-centric flagships with multiple cameras and extreme zoom ranges. Instead, it focuses on delivering a reliable main camera experience that's tuned for those everyday casual photography needs. However, I feel the absence of a dedicated telephoto lens looks a bit questionable especially since the last generation had one.

The rear cameras consists of a 50MP Sony IMX906 main sensor with optical image stabilisation paired with an 8MP ultra-wide camera. On the front, there's a 32MP selfie camera with autofocus. It can record up to 4K at 120fps videos from the rear camera with both OIS and EIS and support for high-frame-rate slow motion and time-lapse modes.

In daylight, the main camera produces clean, sharp and well-balanced images without pushing colours too hard. Dynamic range is handled sensibly, highlights stay under control, skies retain gradient instead of flattening out and shadow detail is preserved without looking artificial.

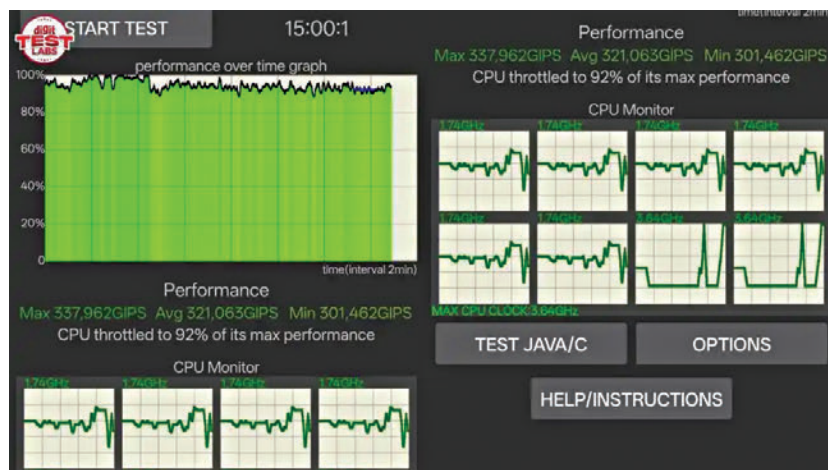
The DetailMax processing does its work quietly in the background, enhancing textures in foliage, pets or busy scenes without making the image look over-processed. There's sharpening, but it's controlled.

Portraits are particularly well executed. Subject separation feels natural, edge detection is clean, and the blur does not appear artificially layered.

Faces retain natural brightness even against strong backlighting, while skies and highlights avoid blowing out.

Zoom is the one area where hardware limitations surface. Cropped 2x shots hold up well thanks to the 50MP sensor but the phone does not extend convincingly beyond that.

Low-light performance is another strength. Neon signage retains colour



integrity, highlights stay controlled, and individual light points remain distinct instead of merging into highlights.

The ultra-wide camera is serviceable and in good light, it works well enough for landscapes and group shots, with edge sharpness and limited distortion.

The 32MP autofocus front camera delivers sharp images with consistent exposure and natural skin tones.

VERDICT

The OnePlus 15R focuses on getting the fundamentals right and then stays consistent at that baseline once you start using it daily.

There are compromises such as the absence of a telephoto camera that feel harder to justify at this price, especially when last year's model offered one. Charging speeds are competitive but no longer class-leading. And while the design is polished, it plays it safe in a market where some buyers may want more personality from their devices.

But the strengths of the 15R more than make up for those shortcomings. The performance is solid and holds up under sustained use, battery life is

dependable with enough headroom, display brightness and colour consistency have improved and the main camera is reliable without overprocessing.

At Rs 47,999, the 15R succeeds because it doesn't ask you to make excuses for it. Rather, it moulds to your expectations and remains calm when pushed hard. This is not a phone that will impress you in the five minutes at the store counter but it earns that over time and that's what the R-series continues to matter in OnePlus' lineup.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 8 Gen 5 | GPU: Adreno 8-series@1225MHz | Display: 6.83-inch FHD+ AMOLED panel | Refresh Rate: 165 Hz | RAM: 12 GB LPDDR5X Ultra | Memory: 256/512 GB UFS 4.1 | Camera (Rear): 50MP + 8MP | Camera (Front): 32MP | Battery: 7400 mAh | Charging: 80W Wired

CONTACT

OnePlus India | Phone: 1800 102 8411 | Email: <https://chat-in.oneplus.com/mailsend/index> | Website: <https://service.oneplus.com/in>

Read more on Digit.in:
tinyurl.com/8hjwe0z